

THE DAILY BRIEF

AUGUST 31, 2026

MARKETS & FINANCE

Macro signals, crypto markets, and prediction-market updates

A federal judge ruled on Friday that the Trump administration's blacklisting of Anthropic — branding the AI lab "woke" — is illegal, striking down the executive-branch maneuver and clearing a path for Anthropic to resume unrestricted federal contracting work. The decision came on the same day a Ninth Circuit panel dealt a separate blow to Kalshi, rejecting the CFTC's claim of exclusive jurisdiction over sports-event contracts in Nevada and opening the door for state-level gambling regulators to assert authority. Crypto markets absorbed two material exploits over the weekend: Crypto.com-linked Cronos halted after a Tectonic exploit drained an estimated \$75 million, and the Fogo Layer 1 mainnet paused when an attacker walked away with 400 million FOGO tokens — roughly 10% of circulating supply. Cosmos Labs separately admitted it wrongly cleared the bug behind a \$5.7 million six-chain hack. On the institutional side, Bitwise's Solana ETF became the first to cross \$1 billion in AUM, Russia's largest bank Sberbank projected \$46 billion in first-year crypto exchange trading under new domestic rules, and SBI Holdings committed \$270 million for a 20% stake in Indonesian digital-asset platform Ajaib.

AI & TECH

Models, labs, infrastructure, and the policy fights shaping the field

Sony Music and Warner Music Group filed suit against Anthropic on Saturday, alleging a "brazen campaign" of intellectual-property theft across millions of copyrighted lyrics — the largest recorded-music action against an AI lab to date. The Anthropic story kept building all week: Ars Technica reports Meta is pushing hard to put humanoid robots to work inside its data centers, while TechCrunch's Nvidia beat argues the company's AI advantage is migrating beyond the GPU into networking, software, and rack-scale systems. OpenAI published its rationale for ending support of coding assistant Cursor following its acquisition by SpaceX, and meeting-notetaker Circleback launched a free tier to broaden its funnel against Otter and Granola. TechCrunch also profiled Caterpillar's deployment playbook — what mining automation taught the heavy-equipment giant about enterprise AI rollouts — and ran a Vijay Pande post on why a16z's former \$4 billion bio lead now writes "30 bets a year" instead of 300.

BRIEFLY

◀ **Bybit** launched 24/7 options on stock perps, beginning with SpaceX and Nvidia — a new vector for retail exposure to private-market names.

- < **IREN's** planned \$25 billion–\$30 billion AI buildout spooked investors, per Bernstein, with shares sliding on capex fears.
- < **Kalshi** became the exclusive prediction-market partner of the US Open, deepening its sports footprint even as the Ninth Circuit ruling lands.
- < **A former White House teleprompter operator** was ordered to pay \$172,000 for unauthorized Kalshi trades on mention markets.
- < **Chainalysis** accused ICE of unfairly steering a \$95 million blockchain-analytics contract to TRM Labs.

THE TAKEAWAY

The two stories that matter most this Monday aren't really about AI — they're about who gets to set the rules. A federal judge just told the executive branch it can't blacklist an AI lab on ideology grounds, and the Ninth Circuit just told the CFTC it doesn't own sports-event prediction markets. Both rulings compress federal power and expand the operating space for the companies Kiran watches — Anthropic, Kalshi, and the broader prediction-market ecosystem. Layer on top of that the Sony/Warner suit against Anthropic (the copyright wars aren't slowing down) and the Cronos/Fogo weekend exploits (smart-contract risk is still very real), and the picture is the same one we've been drawing for a year: the technology is moving fast, the rules are catching up in starts and stops, and the edge belongs to people who can read the regulatory tape as cleanly as the price tape.

Generated by Marvin